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Interview Experience 4+ yoe (2026) – Questions

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Scenario :
You created a UserSession object which is shared across multiple threads.
After deployment, data corruption happens.

Questions:

- How would you redesign the object to make it thread safe?
- How do immutable objects help in concurrency?
- Write the design for a fully immutable class.

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Two threads are updating account balance.
Sometimes balance becomes incorrect.

Questions:

- How will you fix it?
- Options:
  - synchronized
  - ReentrantLock
  - AtomicInteger
- Which one will scale better?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your system processes Kafka messages.

- Producer rate: 5000 messages/sec
- Consumer rate: 1000 messages/sec

After some time system crashes.

Questions

- What is happening internally?
- How would you implement a backpressure mechanism?
- How can BlockingQueue help here?
- How would you scale consumers?

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Large Payload API
Your API receives 100MB JSON payload.
System crashes.
Questions

- What problems arise with large payloads?
- How would you redesign this API?

Possible answers:

- streaming
- multipart uploads
- file storage

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your DB CPU reaches 95%.
Queries are slow.
Questions

- What strategies improve performance?

Possible answers:

- read replicas
- caching
- query optimization
- partitioning

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your application has a thread pool of 100 threads.
But logs show:

- some requests finish quickly
- some requests wait several minutes

Scenario
Some tasks inside threads call blocking I/O operations.
Questions

- What is thread starvation?
- Why does blocking I/O cause it?
- How would you redesign the system?

Expected discussion:

- async processing
- separate pools for blocking tasks
- non-blocking APIs

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

You need to update config values without restarting services.

Questions

- How would you design this?

Possible solutions:

- Spring Cloud Config
- refresh endpoints
- distributed configuration service

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your table contains 1B records.
Queries are slow.
Questions
How would you optimize?
Possible strategies:

- partitioning
- indexing
- archiving old data
- read replicas

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Technical Interview (Scenario-Based)

Your application fails only under heavy load.
Not reproducible locally.
Questions
How would you investigate?
Possible tools:

- distributed tracing
- metrics
- load testing

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- ✓ Real production scenarios
- ✓ Pressure-based mock interviews
- ✓ Decision-making framework
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